

COLUMN | RAJESH CHANDIRAMANI

The Next Big Tech trends of Transformation



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Digital journeys have institutionalized the anytime, anywhere, anyone paradigm. Digital aspirations have driven enterprises of all sizes into an obsession with their customers; an obsession which has aligned operations and strategies alike, to be for the customer, of the customer and by the customer.

To realise their Digital aspirations, organizations are investing heavily in Hyper automation and Cloud Computing as a strategy across all their processes. Hyper-automation, integrating AI (Artificial Intelligence) with RPA (Robotic Process Automation) is enabling organizations to automate repetitive tasks, enhance efficiencies, Cloud Computing to offer significantly more flexibility, scalability, collaboration, and reduced costs.

Companies have extensively adopted smart manufacturing meth-

odologies that have helped improve efficiency and reshape the supply chain. An intelligent supply chain enables organizations to increase visibility, predictability and enhanced control on operations and inventory which aid in effective decision-making.

Smart technologies will offer Predictive Maintenance, Warehouse Automation, Dark factories, Global-level tracking and connected digital logistics. Also, along with features of Industry 4.0, Industry 5.0 will also be a reality in the next 20 years

Technology is changing the nature of service delivery

Technology is now significantly transforming the way services are being designed and delivered. Earlier, a service personnel had to provide support to the customer through their journeys. Not quite so today. The emerging technologies of today offer self-service and automated solutions across various business-processes viz. online airline check-in, self-service checkout lanes in retail stores, gas pumps, and supermarkets.

Today, when contacting customer service, it is mostly an automated operator on the other side or a clever language-program responding when a customer contacts via email. Self-service technologies and automated back-office services can be a delight for the consumers. It enables consumers to receive services right on their premises and get their enquiries processed notably quicker. As a direct fallout of this, the operational costs of the companies decrease with services being delivered at a much lower cost.

The WWW or the 'World-wide Web' brought in a 'world without boundaries'; technology has now expanded our potential to connect

with customers across the globe in ways unheard of before.

Service providers can offer a rich portfolio of services at the lowest-possible cost globally to their connected customers. Technology has enabled the collection and analysis of customer data for analytics and business insights. There is no doubt that the effective usage of such insights and intelligence would be a key lever for gaining competitive advantage for enterprises in the future.

Customer experience drives digital transformation

Digital transformation involves blending of digital technology into all aspects of a business, resulting in fundamental changes in their business operations and business-value delivered to its customers. It is about changing the way a business interacts with customers and provides them a consistent experience anytime and anywhere.

Digital technology has transformed consumer behaviours. Mobile devices, apps, machine learning; automation and many more such technological advancements have allowed customers to avail the services in real-time. The digital paradigm has given birth to the 'modern buyers' who are constantly connected, app-native and tech-savvy. These modern buyers and the new-age customers often rate organizations on their digital customer experience.

Enterprises, hence, consider it imperative to adopt a Digital transformation strategy, which offers them an opportunity to engage with these modern-buyers and provide a seamless customer experience.

With an increasing focus on Autonomy, it is quite likely that Artificial Intelligence will infiltrate into every industry over the next 20 years featuring as a part of their core strategy. Quantum Computing will bring about an unprecedented increase in computational power allowing greater penetration of Artificial Intelligence and help resolve complex business-problems e.g., drug discovery, fraud detection, agricultural transformation and beyond.